

GENDER

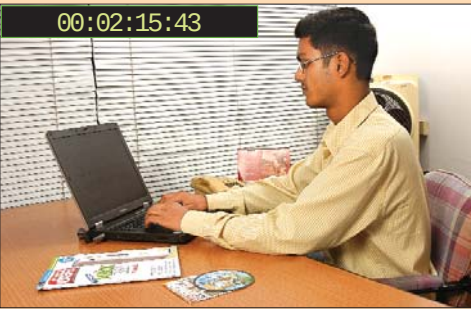
Sudip Mallick vs. Sulbha Chandane



BENDERS

Spend Rs 5,000 on eBay.in

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The task set was simple—to spend Rs 5,000 on eBay.in. As soon as we told Sudip his task, he jumped into the chair and was at e-bay in no time. He seemed to have a clear idea as to what he wanted to buy. He clicked Computer and Peripherals and in the search box typed “graphic card”. After a quick look through the results, he found what he wanted—the XFX GeForce 7300 LE PCI-E 256 MB DDR Graphics Card. Price? Rs 4,700. It was obvious that he’s been to eBay.in quite often looking for the best deal. He still had Rs 300 left, and decided to buy *Moby Dick - The great stories* for Rs 207, and *Peter Pan* for Rs 112. We were secretly hoping he’d buy *Digit*, but as it turns out, he’s a subscriber!

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When we told her the task her face lit up at the prospect of getting to shop for free. She did complain, “Only Rs 5,000?”, when we told her the budget... apparently gold prices have sky-rocketed! She lingered her mouse over the ‘Jewellery’ link before moving it down to ‘Kitchen and Home Appliances’. Here she browsed through Food Processors, Small Appliance Sets, Kitchen Accessories, Ovenware, etc. Finally, she clicked on Ovenware, and a Barbecue Grill made her stop for a moment. Finally, she moved on and found an “LG-SOLO MS-1911-19 Lts MICROWAVE OVEN” for Rs 4,999. She bought it and then gave us one of the broadest smiles we have ever seen!

SEARCH SAFE

Google To Protect From Phishing

Google will now warn you of potentially

unsafe sites in your search results, thanks to its latest tie-up with StopBadware.org. The latter has a huge database of Web sites that distribute malicious software—spyware, spam, and the like—and now these sites will be tagged with this warning in your searches: “Warning – The Website you attempted to visit has

been reported to StopBadware.org as a site that hosts or distributes badware.”

With everyone padding up online security in these increasingly insecure times, the move has widely been heralded as a smart one (much like all things Google). Cases of phishers preying on gullible surfers are on the rise, and while creating complete awareness is the only long-lasting solution, this should help keep the general population out of trouble for a good while.

WEB 2.0 HYPE TOPS ALL

Gartner Releases List Of Hyped Technologies for 2006

Every year, Gartner analyses the impact of 36 up-and-coming technologies and their adoption over the next ten years. This year’s hero: Web 2.0. Gartner puts it at the “peak of inflated expectations”, while mobile phone payments and Enterprise Instant Messaging have moved out of the “trough of disillusionment” and up the “slope of enlightenment”. The hype cycle is defined thus: the product is launched and gets plenty of media attention, which pushes it up to the peak of inflated expectations. It then falls into the trough of

disillusionment as these expectations aren’t met, goes up the slope of enlightenment as people realise its potential and finally comes to rest on the plateau of productivity.

The other two technologies making it to the top three are the Real World Web and Applications Architecture. All three technologies are expected to have huge impacts on business.

Web 2.0, the new Web, is a collection of technologies that enables a more collaborative and social form of Internet, with community-driven content and activities. Ajax is one of the more prominent technologies under this head. Its scope is small, they say—it just makes Web applications a little less difficult to use. However, Gartner assures that even this small impact makes it worth it, for the simple reasons that users will appreciate usability more.

The Real World Web will live in a world where objects aren’t isolated from each other—they will be able to interact and network with their surroundings. These technologies will focus mostly on location-awareness and GPS-enabled devices which will let users take advantage of the fact that their devices know exactly where they are.

Finally, Application Architecture is the infrastructure that lies beneath Web applications. *Event-Driven Architecture* is the future of distributed applications—functions packed into modules and triggered by one or more

Zune

Buzzword of the MONTH

Everybody seems to want to know more about Zune, Microsoft’s upcoming portable media player. Details are being leaked and lapped up. “Is the Zune just the Toshiba Gigabeat with some re-arranged buttons?” asks one Web site. “Microsoft to preload music videos” onto the player, claims another. Then there are the opinions: someone here says it looks

“ugly and plain,” someone else says it’ll definitely “be an iPod killer.” Which seems a rather dubious claim to us. One confident point of speculation is that you can use Wi-Fi to “lend” other Zune owners music for some short period, giving them the opportunity to buy the tracks themselves from the Zune music store.